

10 PAST TENSE OF "BE" (WAS, WERE)

Was and Were

The verb "**be**" in a past simple has two forms: was and were for states (Existence or condition of something or somebody).



KNOW THIS?

We often use the past simple with certain time expressions, e.g., yesterday, yesterday morning/afternoon/evening, last night/week/month/year, on Monday/Tuesday, this morning/afternoon/evening, etc.

Form

 Subject + Was/Were+ extra words

Affirmatives		
Subject	Verb	Extra words
I/ he/ she /it /Ali	was	happy
We / you /they	were	happy

Negatives

Subject	was not/were not	Extra words
I/ he/ she /it /Ali	wasn't	happy
We / you /they	weren't	happy

Questions

Verb	Subject	Extra words
Wasn't	I/ he/ she /it /Ali	happy?
Weren't	we / you /they	happy?



Neil Armstrong **was** the first man on the moon.



It **was** cold this morning!

Exercises

10.1 Circle the correct option.

-  We was / were tired last night.
-  I wasn't / weren't at school last week.
-  You was / were very kind yesterday.
-  It was / were cold last night.
-  My parents was / were at the supermarket this morning.
-  Sami wasn't / weren't happy yesterday.
-  We was / were late this morning.
-  My friends wasn't / weren't in the park this afternoon.
-  She was / were at home all day today.

10.2 Rewrite the sentences in the **past simple**.

 I'm not at home.

I wasn't at home.

 They aren't hungry.

 Sofia isn't here.

 You and I are very lucky.

 I'm busy.

 You're funny!

 The weather is terrible.

10.3

Questions and short answers

ill

hungry

tired

angry

broken

asleep

busy

Was I ____?

Yes, I was. / No, I wasn't.

Were you ____?

Yes, you were. / No, you weren't.

Was he ____?

Yes, he was. / No, he wasn't.

Was she ____?

Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.

Was it ____?

Yes, it was. / No, it wasn't.

Were we ____?

Yes, we were. / No, we weren't.

Were they ____?

Yes, they were. / No, they weren't

10.4

Put the words in order to make questions.

Complete the answers.

 you / at your friend's house / last night / were

Were you at your friend's house last night?

Yes, I was.

 your parents at home / yesterday / were

No, they _____.

 Sami / this morning / on the bus / was

No, he _____.

 it / sunny / was / last Saturday

Yes, it _____.

 in the team / were / last week / you

No, I _____.